

φορήματα) served up after the solid food (σίτα, cf. ἀπὸ δείπνου); the Persians had them, not 'as one course' (ἀλέσει), but at intervals during the meal. H. Rawlinson (*ad loc.*) compares the fondness of the modern Persians for sweetmeats (but these are now served before the meal).

3 Anything that left the body became separated from life and so unclean. For the strange rules of the Avesta on these subjects cf. Fargard, xvii, as to paring the nails; ib. xviii. 40-9, as to the urine (iv. 185, 197).

4 The first part of this custom is ascribed by Tacitus (Germ. 22) to the Germans; he gives the reason 'Deliberant dum fingere nesciunt, constituunt dum errare non possunt' (cf. Mrs. Nickleby, 'Wine in, truth out'). Lack of humour in historians has erected into a system what was merely due to excess.

For Persian drinking cf. Curzon, ii. 506, (The Persian) 'is not a tippler but a toper, not a drinker, but a drunkard', quoting other authorities for the same view.

4 1 H. Rawlinson compares the devotion to etiquette among the modern Persians, 'the Frenchmen of the East'; the salute, however, now is never on the lips.

The prostration of an inferior is familiar in the East (iii. 86. 21; it was as repulsive to the Greeks as the Chinese 'kotow' to Doyle's 'Private of the Buffs'. Cf. vii. 136. 1, and the refusal of Callisthenes to prostrate himself before Alexander (Arr. Anab. iv. 10. 5 seq.).

2 ἀρίστους. The Persian Shah, till he was deposed, was called 'the centre of the Universe'. H., however, makes too systematic the conceit common to all nations, civilized as well as uncivilized.

Two points must be distinguished:

(1) The Persian system of graduated respect.

(2) The Median system of graduated rule, which H. compares to it (§ 3 *ad fin.* 'in the same way as the Persian show degrees of honour').

As to (2) H. is again too systematic, but he represents accurately the broad facts of the contrast between Persian and Median rule; under the Medes, the subject kingdoms paid tribute or sent gifts, while they still ruled their own dependents; under Persia, all districts alike were under the satraps, and in direct relation to the great king (iii. 87 seq.).

3 The sentence is carefully balanced; καὶ τῶν ὁμοῦρων answers to μάλα (= μαλ' αὐτῆς, 'in their turn') τῶν ἐχομένων.

προΐβαινε γὰρ κτλ. is variously explained:

(1) Rawlinson refers τὸ ἔθνος to the Persians; but this is incorrect in fact and spoils the antithesis.

(2) Stein takes it of the Medes; translate 'The race went forward thus ever from government by themselves (ἄρχων) to government through others' (ἐπιτροπεῦον); but it is hard to get this sense out of ἐπιτροπεῦον, which = 'administering' (iii. 36. 3) or 'being regent